

Kara Wang

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EDUCATION

08/23 - 05/27

Westwood High School

Austin, TX

Weighted GPA: 5.91/6.00

AP Exams: AP Statistics: 5, AP Computer Science A: 5, AP Precalculus: 5, AP World History: 5, AP Chinese: 5, AP Human Geography: 5, AP Computer Science Principles: 4

Relevant Coursework: AP Biology, AP Chemistry, AP Environmental Science, AP Calculus AB

RESEARCH/ INTERNSHIPS/ INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

10th - 11th Summer
(2025)

High School Research Academy (UT Austin)

16 Hrs/Wk

Computation Chemistry Science Researcher

5 Wks/Yr

- Evaluated Open Catalyst Project ML models predicting polyethylene glycol adsorption on zinc surfaces by installing and debugging research software
- Compared machine learning potentials with density functional theory simulations
- Presented research poster at symposium and collaborated with a team under the guidance of Dr. Wenrui Chai

10th - 11th Summer
(2025)

Elio Research Academy

40 Hrs/Wk

Biochemistry & Pharmacology Remote Researcher

2 Wks/Yr

- Studied biochemical pathways and pharmacologic mechanisms of imatinib resistance in CML
- Analyzed signaling pathways (PI3K/Akt/mTOR, NF-kB) using literature databases like PubMed and PubChem, and created pathway visualizations using BioRender
- Presented research remotely to a group of ~30 students and adults

11th - Present

Independent Research - CASGEVY Gene Editing Therapy

2 Hrs/Wk

Independent Researcher

11 Wks/Yr

- Investigated CRISPR-based therapy mechanisms for sickle cell disease using NCBI literature

- Evaluated treatment efficacy, risks, ethical concerns, and accessibility challenges
- Analyzed advantages and limitations of gene-editing therapies in clinical practice
- Written analysis evaluating personal medical decision-making relating to CASGEVY

VOLUNTEERING

9 th - Present	Project Melody <i>Volunteer Musician</i>	3 Hrs/Wk 7 Wks/Yr
	• Performed violin and piano at senior homes to enhance resident engagement, well-being, and connection • Independently learned new repertoire outside scheduled rehearsals and performances • Assisted with concert coordination and resident interaction	
11 th	SmileCard	1 Hrs/Wk 15 Wks/Yr
	• Wrote ~75 supportive letters and cards to socially isolated seniors nationwide • Promoted emotional connection and mental well-being	
9 th	CleanerAustin	2 Hrs/Wk 4 Wks/Yr
	• Collaborated with community volunteers to clean and restore local parks in the Austin area • Supported environmental sustainability and maintained public spaces	

ACTIVITIES

11 th	International Internship Program <i>Health Education Intern Contributor</i>	3 Hrs/Wk 27 Wks/Yr
	• Co-designed and analyzed a community baseline health survey assessing needs relating to the first 1000 days of child development illness in the Bayara South Community (Nigeria), researching disease prevention and identifying barriers to care through community data analysis • Developed culturally appropriate health education workshop, planned out curriculum materials, and wrote a facilitator handbook enabling local partners to implement sustainable community program • Collaborated in weekly international coordination meetings to ensure cultural relevance, clear communication, and real-world applicability of project outcomes • Fundraised ~\$350 for the Bayara-South community, supporting local health education initiatives	
11 th - Present	Letter Companionship Project (Beginning/Launching) <i>Founder</i>	1 Hrs/Wk 5 Wks/Yr

	- Created a pen-pal program connecting isolated seniors with student volunteers, promoting emotional and social connection - Facilitated weekly letter exchanges and managed material transport logistics - Coordinated volunteer recruitment, communication, and hour tracking	
9 th - Present	MTY Math Academy <i>Paid Teaching Assistant & Homework Grader</i> - Graded coursework for classes of 20-30 students every two weeks, ensuring accuracy and timely feedback - Provided constructive feedback and homework assistance to strengthen student understanding - Identified common learning challenges and communicated trends through reports to instructors to support lesson planning - Recognized by program leadership for thorough and thoughtful feedback	3 Hrs/Wk 20 Wks/Yr
9 th - Present	Westwood HS Orchestra <i>Symphony Orch (11th), Philharmonic (9th, 11th)</i> - First chair (freshman concert cycle; sophomore entire year) - Led sectional rehearsals and performed solo passages twice - The Philharmonic Orchestra competed in UIL Full Orchestra competitions as the varsity ensemble, winning all 1s at UIL - Symphony Orchestra Ensemble Achievements: National Orchestra Cup (Lincoln Center) 2026 1st Runner Up, TMEA #1 Texas Honor Full Orchestra 2026	6 Hrs/Wk 36 Wks/Yr
11 th - Present	Orchestra Officer <i>Officer</i> - Selected through a competitive application and interview process, proposing program improvements and outreach initiatives - Managed orchestra event calendar (Reserved for 1-2 people) and communication updates - Designed promotional materials for social events and supported program events - Led outreach initiatives, strengthening orchestra community engagement by up to 1.5x compared to previous years in some socials	2.5 Hrs/Wk 36 Wks/Yr
9 th - 10 th	Austin Youth Orchestra <i>Symphony Member</i> - Performed in nationally recognized youth ensemble concerts, including performances at the UT Bates Recital Hall in 2025 - Participated in intensive 2.5-hour-long rehearsals	2.5 Hrs/Wk 33 Wks/Yr

	Ensemble Achievements: Orchestra selected as a National Winner in the Mark of Excellence/National Orchestra Honors Project	
11 th	HOSA Club <i>Member and Competitor</i> - Participated in Health Informatics testing events - Participated in fundraising, social, and service events	2 Hrs/Wk 25 Wks/Yr
11 th	MEDLIFE Club Participated in meetings, fundraising, social, and service initiatives supporting global health awareness and medical relief efforts.	1 Hrs/Wk 9 Wks/Yr
9 th - 10 th	DECA Club <i>Member and Competitor</i> - Completed Hospitality & Tourism Operations Research and Business Management Operations Research Events - Designed Research studies analyzing local business operations - Produced written strategic plans and outlines (20 pages) and presented solutions at district competition conferences	3 Hrs/Wk 28 Wks/Yr
2023 Summer + 2024 Summer	Kyros Co-Creator Program <i>Intern Student</i> - Collaborated with industry mentors in product design and development - Created a character concept, later used as inspiration for an official website design (2024)	10 Hrs/Wk 4 Wks/Yr
10 th Summer (2024)	Kyros Industry Immersion - Wall Street Investment <i>Intern Student</i> Completed industry analysis and financial modeling projects, including DCF valuation, financial statement analysis, and a private equity investment capstone.	15 Hrs/Wk 4 Wks/Yr

HONORS & AWARDS

11 th	Duke of Edinburgh's International Award Bronze (2026) - Completed a rigorous self-development program involving 12+ months of voluntary service, physical activity, and skill development - Organized and executed a 2-day 1-night adventurous hiking and camping journey, demonstrating leadership, team collaboration, and resilience under challenging conditions - Enhanced community engagement through weekly volunteering, developing strong interpersonal and empathy skills
11 th	Barbara James Volunteer Service Award Bronze (Pending)

9 th - Present	- Submitted at least 100 hours of community health and medical volunteer service for international recognition. Texas Federation of Music Clubs Competition <i>Violin Competitor</i> - All-State Winner (5x) - Solo, Duet, & Concerto Events (2023-2024) - Superior ratings at District Festival - Duet, Solo, Concerto, Quartet Ensemble (2023-2026) - Advanced from district competition with Superior ratings and selected as top performer in category statewide for All State 5x (one winner per division) 2025 No State Competition, 2026 State results pending
9 th - 10 th	Janice Kay Hodges Piano Competition 2nd Place; 3rd Place (2x) - 2023-2025 - Prepared contemporary piano repertoire, engaging in music by living composers alongside traditional works
10 th	AP Scholar With Distinction Earned top scores on 5 AP exams, reflecting academic excellence.
10 th	IT Specialist Java Certification Certified in Java programming fundamentals, showcasing technical proficiency

SKILLS, TALENTS & ACHIEVEMENTS

Computer & Technical Skills

- Java, Python, HTML, a little bit of R
- BioRender scientific visualization and PubMed and PubChem navigation

Languages

- English, Chinese
- State Seal of Biliteracy for Chinese (2025): Recognized proficiency in speaking, reading, and writing Chinese.

Musical Instruments

- Studied piano since kindergarten and violin since 4th grade
- Practiced repertoire beyond ensemble requirements and prepared music for performances, volunteer concerts, and competitions.